

HMF Design Clinic

Team Workbook

Cedarline Health Group · 4 use cases · 27 customer pain points · 400 points

Your team

Team name

Team members

Date

How this workbook works

1. You are a team of Cisco Solution Engineers helping **Cedarline Health Group**. Read their situation and the guidance overleaf, then work the four use cases in order.
2. Each use case lists the customer's **pain points**. For each one you take on, fill the two answer boxes: the **Product / platform** that solves it, and the **Solution Engineer response** — how it addresses the concern and how it helps.
3. Your proctor assigns which pain points to answer. Each use case is scored out of 100 — four make **400**.

Your four use cases

- ☐ **1** AI Security — 7 pain points
- ☐ **2** Cloud Edge — 6 pain points
- ☐ **3** DC Edge · Perimeter Firewall — 5 pain points
- ☐ **4** Macro & Micro Segmentation — 9 pain points

GUIDANCE

How to write a great answer

For every pain point you answer, give **two things**:

1. **Product / platform** — name a specific Cisco product, not a category. e.g. “Cisco AI Defense,” not “an AI tool.”
2. **SE response** — explain in two moves: **how it addresses the concern**, then **how it helps Cedarline** (the outcome, tied to their real constraints).

✗ WEAK — SCORES LOW

PRODUCT

A firewall.

SE RESPONSE

It would improve security and give better protection.

✓ STRONG — SCORES HIGH

PRODUCT

Cisco Secure Firewall with the Encrypted Visibility Engine (EVE).

SE RESPONSE

EVE fingerprints threats **inside encrypted traffic without decrypting it** — so Cedarline keeps visibility while respecting Compliance’s ban on decrypting clinical traffic, and closes the four-day dwell-time gap.

REMEMBER Half the marks are the reasoning. A product name with no reasoning scores low; reasoning that could be true for any customer scores in the middle; reasoning that turns on something **Cedarline** said scores high.

The customer — Cedarline Health Group

A regional healthcare payer-provider: ~8,000 staff across four hospitals and thirty-one clinics, plus a claims-processing business. Grown by acquisition (a second data centre absorbed as-is) and mid-flight into public cloud, now running AI workloads across it. After a March security incident the board asked what would have stopped it — and leadership still can’t answer. Budget and executive attention are approved, but temporary. Encrypted (TLS) everywhere; two flat/inherited data centres run by two engineers; AWS + Azure + GCP with AI assets appearing faster than security can track.

1

USE CASE 1 OF 4 · AI DEFENSE · RUNTIME, COMPLIANCE, SUPPLY CHAIN

AI Security

Why this matters. Cedarline's AI apps are live and exposed, and AI assets are spreading across the clouds faster than security can see them.

TIP Most answers here are Cisco AI Defense capabilities — runtime guardrails, model/app validation, supply-chain scanning, AI cloud visibility — plus ISE for device visibility.

This use case has **7 customer pain points**. Answer the ones your proctor assigns — each use case is scored out of 100.

1 Pain point 1

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"Our production AI applications are exposed to users, and we are worried about adversarial attacks like prompt injection or data exfiltration. How do we protect these apps in real-time without slowing down the user experience?"

1 PRODUCT / PLATFORM — name the Cisco product or platform

2 SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE — how it addresses the concern, and how it helps Cedarline

2 Pain point 2

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"Under the EU AI Act, we are classified as a 'Provider' for our internal AI systems. We need to demonstrate robustness and cybersecurity compliance to satisfy Article 15. How does Cisco help us meet these specific requirements?"

1 PRODUCT / PLATFORM — name the Cisco product or platform

2 SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE — how it addresses the concern, and how it helps Cedarline

3 Pain point 3

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"We are integrating various open-source models and third-party agents into our internal workflows. How can we ensure these assets aren't introducing vulnerabilities into our environment before they even go live?"

1 PRODUCT / PLATFORM — name the Cisco product or platform

2 SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE — how it addresses the concern, and how it helps Cedarline

4 Pain point 4

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"We have thousands of IoT devices, printers, and guest users connecting to our network. We have no visibility into what these devices are or if they are compromised, leaving us vulnerable to unauthorized access."

1 PRODUCT / PLATFORM — name the Cisco product or platform

2 SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE — how it addresses the concern, and how it helps Cedarline

5 Pain point 5

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"We know AI is showing up across our cloud environments faster than security can track it. We're worried we have models, agents, datasets, and MCP-connected tools running without visibility or consistent controls."

1 PRODUCT / PLATFORM — name the Cisco product or platform

2 SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE — how it addresses the concern, and how it helps Cedarline

6 Pain point 6

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"We're concerned that vulnerable or compromised models, repositories, or MCP servers could enter development before we catch them. Traditional controls aren't designed to inspect the AI supply chain."

1 **PRODUCT / PLATFORM** — name the Cisco product or platform

2 **SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE** — how it addresses the concern, and how it helps Cedarline

7 Pain point 7

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"We're running AI workloads in cloud accounts, but we don't have a reliable way to see which models and AI assets are actually in use. We're also concerned about workloads reaching out to third-party AI models without security knowing about it. And even when we do know the traffic path, we need a practical way to inspect and enforce guardrails on prompt and response traffic in the cloud without changing every application."

1 **PRODUCT / PLATFORM** — name the Cisco product or platform

2 **SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE** — how it addresses the concern, and how it helps Cedarline

PROCTOR — SCORE

_____ / 100

Notes

2

USE CASE 2 OF 4 · MULTICLOUD · CONSISTENCY & CONTAINMENT

Cloud Edge

Why this matters. Workloads sprawl across AWS, Azure, GCP and on-prem — inconsistent policy, drift, and lateral-movement risk.

TIP Think one control plane: Multicloud Defense + Security Cloud Control; ISE for consistent identity-based access.

This use case has **6 customer pain points**. Answer the ones your proctor assigns — each use case is scored out of 100.

1 Pain point 1

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"We're deploying across AWS, Azure, and GCP, but each cloud has its own constructs and workflows."

1 PRODUCT / PLATFORM — name the Cisco product or platform

2 SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE — how it addresses the concern, and how it helps Cedarline

2 Pain point 2

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"If a breach occurs in one of our public cloud instances, we are terrified that the attacker will move laterally into our core on-premises systems. How can we contain these threats in a multicloud environment?"

1 **PRODUCT / PLATFORM** — name the Cisco product or platform

2 **SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE** — how it addresses the concern, and how it helps Cedarline

3 Pain point 3

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"Our auditors require proof that our security controls are applied consistently across all our cloud workloads. Gathering this data from different cloud providers is a manual, time-consuming nightmare."

1 **PRODUCT / PLATFORM** — name the Cisco product or platform

2 **SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE** — how it addresses the concern, and how it helps Cedarline

4 Pain point 4

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"Our employees work from the office, home, and coffee shops. We are struggling to maintain a consistent security policy across these different locations, leading to complex, fragmented rule sets that are hard to manage."

1 **PRODUCT / PLATFORM** — name the Cisco product or platform

2 **SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE** — how it addresses the concern, and how it helps Cedarline

5 Pain point 5

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"We have workloads spread across AWS, Azure, and on-premises data centers. Managing security policies individually in each cloud environment is creating massive operational overhead and leading to inconsistent security posture."

1 **PRODUCT / PLATFORM** — name the Cisco product or platform

2 **SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE** — how it addresses the concern, and how it helps Cedarline

6 Pain point 6

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"We have workloads on-prem, in cloud, and in mixed environments, and policy consistency is becoming difficult. Every environment feels different, and we're worried about drift."

1 PRODUCT / PLATFORM — name the Cisco product or platform

2 SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE — how it addresses the concern, and how it helps Cedarline

PROCTOR — SCORE

_____ / 100

Notes

3

USE CASE 3 OF 4 · PERIMETER · VISIBILITY & POLICY

DC Edge · Perimeter Firewall

Why this matters. A complex, mixed-vendor firewall estate with encrypted blind spots, unknown threats, and slow manual response.

TIP Secure Firewall + FMC + Security Cloud Control; EVE for encrypted visibility, Snort ML for unknown threats, ISE for automated response.

This use case has **5 customer pain points**. Answer the ones your proctor assigns — each use case is scored out of 100.

1 Pain point 1

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"When our security tools detect a compromised device, our manual response time is too slow. By the time we identify the user and manually isolate the port, the attacker has already moved through the network."

1 PRODUCT / PLATFORM — name the Cisco product or platform

2 SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE — how it addresses the concern, and how it helps Cedarline

2 Pain point 2

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"We're worried that once an attacker gets into the environment, they can move laterally across applications."

1 **PRODUCT / PLATFORM** — name the Cisco product or platform

2 **SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE** — how it addresses the concern, and how it helps Cedarline

3 Pain point 3

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"Our firewall environment has become too complex to manage manually."

1 **PRODUCT / PLATFORM** — name the Cisco product or platform

2 **SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE** — how it addresses the concern, and how it helps Cedarline

4 Pain point 4

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"Most of our traffic is encrypted, so we've lost visibility into a huge part of our environment."

1 **PRODUCT / PLATFORM** — name the Cisco product or platform

2 **SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE** — how it addresses the concern, and how it helps Cedarline

5 Pain point 5

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"We're worried traditional signature-based detection won't catch new or unknown attacks quickly enough."

1 **PRODUCT / PLATFORM** — name the Cisco product or platform

2 **SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE** — how it addresses the concern, and how it helps Cedarline

PROCTOR — SCORE

_____ / 100

Notes

4

USE CASE 4 OF 4 · EAST-WEST · WORKLOAD & KUBERNETES

Macro & Micro Segmentation

Why this matters. The data centre and Kubernetes are wide open east-west; policy must follow the workload — safely, without breaking apps.

TIP Secure Workload for dependency-aware policy, Hypershield / N9300 for fabric enforcement, Isovalent Cilium + Tetragon for Kubernetes.

This use case has **9 customer pain points**. Answer the ones your proctor assigns — each use case is scored out of 100.

1 Pain point 1

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"We don't feel like we have enough control over east-west movement inside the data center."

1 PRODUCT / PLATFORM — name the Cisco product or platform

2 SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE — how it addresses the concern, and how it helps Cedarline

2 Pain point 2

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"Network policy helps, but we also need to know what's happening at runtime inside the workload. We need better detection of suspicious behavior and policy violations."

1 PRODUCT / PLATFORM — name the Cisco product or platform

2 SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE — how it addresses the concern, and how it helps Cedarline

3 Pain point 3

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"Our Kubernetes environment changes too fast for traditional segmentation approaches. We need policy at the service and container level, with visibility into microservice communication."

1 **PRODUCT / PLATFORM** — name the Cisco product or platform

2 **SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE** — how it addresses the concern, and how it helps Cedarline

4 Pain point 4

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"Our Kubernetes networking feels fragmented across clusters and environments. We're dealing with too many moving parts, inconsistent policies, and too much operational complexity."

1 **PRODUCT / PLATFORM** — name the Cisco product or platform

2 **SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE** — how it addresses the concern, and how it helps Cedarline

5 Pain point 5

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"Pods and services are constantly changing, so traditional IP-based policy is hard to maintain. We need segmentation that actually follows the application."

1 **PRODUCT / PLATFORM** — name the Cisco product or platform

2 **SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE** — how it addresses the concern, and how it helps Cedarline

6 Pain point 6

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"Right now we're stitching together separate tools for networking, security, and observability in Kubernetes, and it's creating too much overhead."

1 **PRODUCT / PLATFORM** — name the Cisco product or platform

2 **SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE** — how it addresses the concern, and how it helps Cedarline

7 Pain point 7

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"We know we need microsegmentation, but we don't have enough visibility into east-west flows or application dependencies to create policy safely. We don't want to break the application."

1 **PRODUCT / PLATFORM** — name the Cisco product or platform

2 **SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE** — how it addresses the concern, and how it helps Cedarline

8 Pain point 8

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"We like the idea of workload-level enforcement, but in some environments we can't install agents on every system. We still need segmentation coverage for those workloads."

1 **PRODUCT / PLATFORM** — name the Cisco product or platform

2 **SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE** — how it addresses the concern, and how it helps Cedarline

9 Pain point 9

THE CUSTOMER SAYS

"We need Kubernetes networking and security that can perform at scale, support mission-critical workloads, and integrate with the rest of our enterprise tooling."

1 PRODUCT / PLATFORM — name the Cisco product or platform

2 SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE — how it addresses the concern, and how it helps Cedarline

PROCTOR — SCORE

_____ / 100

Notes

FINISH

Your scoreboard

#	Use case	Score
1	AI Security (7 pain points)	_____ / 100
2	Cloud Edge (6 pain points)	_____ / 100
3	DC Edge · Perimeter Firewall (5 pain points)	_____ / 100
4	Macro & Micro Segmentation (9 pain points)	_____ / 100
TOTAL		_____ / 400

Well played. You turned a pile of problems into a plan — the way a great SE does in the real room.

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